

Porcine Tissue Supplier Study

Deep Study — Multi-Agent Re-Research with Adversarial Verification, plus the open-capacity re-investigation. 21 agents · 121 facility records · 10 candidates attacked by skeptic agents; then 3 further sweeps that retrieved USDA's primary FSIS datasets and expanded the roster to 91 facilities across four volume tiers. Read the ADDENDUM first — it corrects the synthesis that follows wherever the two conflict.

*Added after this synthesis was written. Capacity was re-opened (no size filter) and volume re-classified into four tiers: **Small 0–300/wk · Medium 350–2,500/wk · Medium-High 2,500–5,000/wk · High >5,000/wk**. Three further sweeps ran, two of which **defeated the FSIS Akamai block** with full browser headers and pulled USDA's primary datasets. Roster expanded **44 → 91 facilities**. Where this addendum conflicts with the synthesis below, **the addendum wins**.*

What is now source-of-truth rather than inference

The MPI Directory (7,225 active establishments), the Establishment Demographic Data — carrying explicit `sow_slaughter / market_swine_slaughter / boar_stag_swine_slaughter` **flags**, which is USDA's own answer on animal class — the Inactive Directory (932 records), and ten Quarterly Enforcement Reports (FY24 Q1–FY26 Q2) were all retrieved directly. Establishment numbers, species class and enforcement below come from those files.

The Medium-High band is enumerable. FSIS `slaughter_volume_category` 4 spans 100,000–10,000,000 head/yr, so 2,500–5,000/wk (~125k–250k/yr) sits at its bottom. Only **49 category-4 swine establishments exist nationally** — all enumerated. A category-3 plant tops out near 2,000/wk and *mathematically cannot* be in the band.

Findings that are now REFUTED

- **Gunnoe Sausage (Goode VA) is CLOSED.** Shut November 2022 after 57 years (~30 staff); brand sold to Logan's Sausage; real estate auctioned and marked **SOLD 15 Nov 2024**. Absent from **both** the active and inactive FSIS directories. This synthesis called it "Virginia's only genuinely in-band plant" — **that is wrong. Remove it from the pipeline.**
- **Kansas City Sausage / Coastal Protein (Godwin NC) does not slaughter.** No active FSIS establishment exists in Godwin, zip 28344, or on Martin Road. It is a sausage **manufacturing** plant that *consumes* sows; its associated abattoir is Martin's Pork Products. The "3,500–5,000 sows/wk" premise is unsupported.
- **Martin's Pork Products is FSIS category 3 — under 2,000/wk.** This *confirms* the synthesis's revision downward and kills the 6,500/wk EMI-derived figure for good. Martin's is **Medium tier**.
- **Most named leads were below the band, not in it:** F.B. Purnell, Pioneer, both Bob Evans plants and Carlton are category 3; **Dean Sausage is category 2** (~20–200/wk, two orders of magnitude below its reputed 300 sows/day).
- **Plants that no longer slaughter:** Masami Foods (exited; also a 2018 citation for a worker slitting a **conscious** pig's throat), Dayton Meat Products (no federal grant), Fisher Ham Navasota (does not exist; Spring TX is custom-exempt/state only). **Johnsonville's Momence IL sow plant closed June 2025**, removing a large chunk of national sow capacity.

New leading candidates

1. **Pioneer Packing (M372, Bowling Green OH)** — the cleanest **sow+boar-only** signature in USDA's data, ~2,250–2,430/wk. Decisively, they specialise in **pre-rigor whole-hog pork** — product off the floor within ~1–1¼ hours post-mortem. **A plant already engineered around sub-2-hour warm-carcass throughput is structurally the closest thing to a tissue-harvest operation in the entire study.**

2. **Peoria Packing (M21651, Grant Park IL)** — a sleeper nobody had surfaced. Their own site states capital improvements "support our ability to supply high-grade products to the medical and pharmaceutical industries" and that they are "flexible enough to meet our customers' unique specifications."
3. **Leidy's (M9520, Souderton PA)** — export-certified and ~5 miles from Animal Biotech Industries' lab. All 73 PA federally-inspected swine plants were enumerated; ABI sits ~5 mi from both Clemens (Hatfield) and Leidy's, and LAMPIRE (Pipersville) ~12 mi from the same cluster. *This is a labelled inference — neither firm names its abattoirs —* but asking whether their technicians already harvest there is the highest-value question in the outreach list, because a yes means a **proven Model A precedent**.

Two strategic facts

- **Sustainable Swine Resources is a direct competitor** — self-described "largest U.S. supplier of sow tissue," running ISO 22442-2, SQF-certified **GMP medical-material rooms and a Customization Center adjacent to the harvest floor** — and it operates **two of the six in-band plants** (Perry Way, Watertown WI; Banner Creek, Holton KS). Model A access may be refused on channel conflict. Read them regardless.
- **Several plants already hold a VOLUNTARY (V) grant** — Carlton, Swaggerty, Springfield Meat, Lehigh Valley, Smucker's. Voluntary inspection is the mechanism USDA uses for **non-amenable / non-food-use** product, i.e. the regulatory scaffolding for biomedical harvest already exists at those establishments.

Welfare findings that bear on the humane-treatment criterion

Calihan (Peoria IL) — **two inhumane-handling suspensions in two years**, including a failed captive-bolt stun on a conscious, vocalising boar; FSIS wrote its "robust" humane programme "failed to effectively implement." Clausen (Turlock CA) — suspended ~5 months. Bob Evans Xenia — 2018 **egregious** NOIE (moribund sow conscious after the first stun, three attempts). Dean Sausage — **7 repeat OSHA violations** including blocked exits, which makes placing our own crew inside a live safety exposure. The Pork Company (Warsaw NC, ~7,500/wk) — the region's real volume prize, but an INH suspension in May 2025.

*Prepared 2026-08-03. Every claim below is traceable to the research and verification passes supplied; nothing is added. Confidence labels: **VERIFIED** (primary source cited in the underlying work), **INFERRED** (reasoned from verified facts), **UNVERIFIED** (asserted but not confirmed), **NONE FOUND** (absence of public record, which is not proof of a clean record).*

1. TOP TEN KEY FINDINGS

Ranked by decision impact.

1. **Nahunta is not your sentimental incumbent — it is your best-evidenced candidate, because it already does exactly what you want: it publishes a "Specimen Permits" page routing research and educational institutions to the NCDA&CS Meat & Poultry Inspection specimen request form.** (**VERIFIED** — nahuntapork.com/specimen-permits1) This single finding overturns the earlier file's "organ capability: none published" and de-risks the entire Model A conversation; you are not asking them to do something new, you are asking them to scale something they already advertise.
2. **Martin's Pork Products is back inside your volume band — the "6,500 hogs/week, above your ceiling" figure that kept it at arm's length does not survive scrutiny.** (**REFUTED**) The 1,300 head/day EMI entry is contradicted by Talmadge-Aiken's small-plant structure, ~75 employees, zero EPA permits in Falcon, and a ~9.4-acre county property footprint with one 1,484 sq ft building; the labelled estimate is now **200–1,500 hogs/week — most likely in band**, and the plant is confirmed active on the NCDA&CS TA directory PDF generated 2026-07-24.

3. Your supply chain has to split in two, because your best-culture plant can never ship to Europe. Nahunta slaughters under NC state grant P-80A only, and NCDA&CS states plainly that state-inspected product may be sold in NC only (*VERIFIED*); EU Category 3 status under Reg. 1069/2009 requires material from animals passed ante-/post-mortem in a slaughterhouse (*VERIFIED*). **Domestic models can come from Nahunta; EU-bound models cannot.**

4. You have been aiming at the wrong export list — your product is an animal by-product, and APHIS Veterinary Services, not FSIS, is the certifying authority. (*VERIFIED — aphis.usda.gov/animal-product-export: APHIS certifies animal products not intended for human consumption; FSIS/FDA handle products intended for human consumption.*) A plant on the FSIS "Eligible U.S. Establishments — EU / Pork" list is **not** thereby approved to send research tissue to Europe, and a dedicated biologics harvester could be APHIS-listed for ABP while appearing on no FSIS list at all. Track these as two independent yes/no columns and never accept "yes, we're EU approved" without asking *which list*.

5. Your 200–3,000 hogs/week band describes a structural hole in the US pork industry: by the industry's own capacity census only ~17 plants nationally sit inside it, of which 8 are cull-sow plants — leaving roughly nine market-hog plants in the entire country, and exactly one in the four states studied. (*INFERRED from the EMI Analytics Fall 2017 capacity table, obtained in full*) This is the single most important strategic fact in the study and it means a single-plant, single-source strategy at the top of your band is probably not purchasable.

6. Whether your models can use cull-sow anatomy is a client-side question that decides the fate of roughly half the candidate pool, and no amount of further research can answer it. Swaggerty (*FSIS species flags: sow_slaughter=Yes, market_swine BLANK — VERIFIED*), Wampler's, Williams/Tyson, Kansas City Sausage and Gunnoe are all sow plants; a heavily parous sow has a remodelled birth canal and stretched abdominal wall, which is either disqualifying for pelvic and bariatric blocks or a premium urogynaecology asset. **Answer this internally before another hour of sourcing effort is spent.**

7. Not one facility in the entire 121-record study has been verified as APHIS-listed or EU/TRACES-listed — including Smithfield BioScience. (*UNVERIFIED across the board.*) FSIS was Akamai-403 and proxy-502 to every automated request, usda-eu.org returned 503, and TRACES-NT is a JavaScript app browsable by a human but not by automation. Your European route is currently an assumption, not a finding.

8. Every "clean welfare record" in this study means "nothing surfaced in reachable sources" — and each of the three times a verifier actually dug, the record was not clean. T&E Meats: two FSIS egregious humane-handling incidents including a *large hog that regained consciousness on the bleed rail* (NOIE 2023-11-22) and a large sow requiring multiple captive-bolt attempts (NOROS 2024-04-25). Piedmont: a 2021 humane-handling NR. Williams Sausage: a 2022 humane-handling non-compliance **and an FSIS Notice of Suspension of slaughter HACCP dated 2025-07-15.** (*All VERIFIED from primary FSIS correspondence.*)

9. Two welfare certifications that were doing heavy lifting in the earlier pass are refuted or unsupported. Williamsburg Packing appears in **neither** Certified Humane's nor A Greener World's own directories (*REFUTED — likely conflated with Caw Caw Creek Farm, a certified farm, not a plant*); EcoFriendly Foods advertises a "Certified Humane processing facility" but the only verifiable HFAC record is a **2010 distributor certification** (*REFUTED as a current plant certification — and a live diligence flag for a client selling on welfare credibility*).

10. Virginia's only genuinely in-band plant was never researched, and it sits in the same county as the plant the VA section recommended. Gunnoe Sausage Company, 3989 Cifax Rd, Goode VA 24556, (540) 586-1091 — a dedicated sow slaughterhouse operating since 1965 at 90–110 head/day (~450–590 hogs/week) in Bedford County — clears your 200/wk floor, whereas EcoFriendly Foods (the section's original STRONG FIT) is roughly an order of magnitude below it at an estimated 20–80 hogs/week.

Bonus, and arguably #1 for next-step ROI: the highest-value supplier class in this market was catalogued and then dismissed. Heparin/mucosa/natural-casing collectors — Scientific Protein Laboratories (Waunakee WI), DeWied International (San Antonio TX, merged with Oversea Casing 2018) — **already run your Operating Model A at industrial scale:** their own crews, inside third-party USDA plants, recovering one tissue under written protocol, paying for line position. Their collection networks are a ready-made map of which US plants accept third-party harvest crews and on what commercial terms.

2. RECOMMENDED CONTACT ORDER

Weighted for: verified-open + in-band volume + welfare record that survived adversarial review + evidenced organ/viscera handling. Downgraded candidates are deliberately held below the fold.

#	Facility	Why it's here	The ONE thing to confirm on the call
1	Nahunta Slaughter House, Inc. — Est. P-80A, 200 Bertie Pierce Rd, Pikeville NC · (919) 242-4735	Only candidate with a published research-specimen pathway and fresh spleens, hearts and livers as standing retail SKUs — direct evidence viscera leave the kill floor intact. Culture benchmark, verified swine-only, verified open on a regulator PDF dated 2026-07-24.	"How many hogs do you KILL per week under P-80A, and how many carcasses do you buy in for P-80?" The 500+/wk figure says processes, and is attributed to the processing entity.
2	Martin's Pork Products, Inc. — Est. TA-6720, PO Box 56, Falcon NC · (910) 980-1501	The only verified hog-only, federally-inspected, export-structurally-eligible plant that is plausibly in your band — and an incumbent, so the call is cheap. Volume objection has evaporated.	Actual current head/week, and who owns the plant today — county deeds show land purchases Aug/Nov 2021 beside a claimed 2022 grant date, so your incumbent read on culture may be stale. Do not travel to "6657 Kings Street"; three sources disagree on the street address.
3	Larry's Sausage Company, Inc. — Est. TA-8305, Fayetteville NC	Closest structural analogue to Nahunta but with federal/exportable TA inspection : swine-only, family-owned since 1952, three generations. <i>Flag: this candidate was never adversarially verified — treat its profile at the same confidence level as the pre-verification file that failed elsewhere.</i>	Actual weekly kill. The 200–800/wk figure is a labelled estimate from distribution footprint, nothing more. That number decides everything.
4	Bass Farms, Inc. — Est. TA-3521, Spring Hope NC	NCDA&CS lists it " Slaughter only, species C (swine) " — a hog kill floor with no processing attached is the purest Model A structure in the state. <i>Also never adversarially verified.</i>	Current federal grant status. No matching federal M3521 record surfaced in FSIS-derived data — confirm the TA grant is live before anything else.
5	Gunnoe Sausage Company — 3989 Cifax Rd, Goode VA 24556 · (540) 586-1091	Newly surfaced and never researched : dedicated sow slaughterhouse since 1965 at ~450–590 hogs/week — genuinely in band, and Virginia's only such plant.	Establishment number and inspection status (not captured), then sow-vs-market-hog and whether they'd host a third-party harvest crew.
6	Smithfield BioScience — harvest base Tar Heel NC (Est. M18079/V18079)	The only verified organ programme anywhere in the study — aortas, heart valves, pericardium, peritoneum, mucosa, pancreas, pituitary, tendons — plus stated farm-to-processing traceability and existing EU pharmaceutical trade.	"Will you harvest multi-organ regional BLOCKS to our written spec, and which APHIS/EU listings do you already hold for research-use material?" Handle as competitive intelligence too: they may see you as a rival, not a customer.
7	Kansas City Sausage Co., LLC dba Coastal Protein — 1600 Martin Road, Godwin NC	Confirmed operating via live EPA CAA ("Operating") and NPDES NCG060100 ("Effective" to 2031) permits. ~3,500–5,000 sows/wk — marginally above ceiling, but sow anatomy is closer to adult human scale than a 250 lb market hog.	The establishment number , which no public source in this study could produce — plus whether a dedicated harvest bench is negotiable.
8	Wampler's Farm Sausage Co., Inc. — Est. M9065+P9065+V9065, 781 Highway 70 W, Lenoir City TN · (865) 986-2056 (FSIS plant line, not 1-800-SAUSAGE)	Real federal grant, real kill floor, ~1,500–1,620/wk at 2017 rated capacity, family-owned since 1937.	Sows only, or any market hogs — and actual current weekly head. If the answer is "sows only," this drops to REFERENCE and should not consume a site visit. Identity trap: the July 2026 story about a 73-year employee is about Family Brands, LLC (Est. M6515) , a different plant in the same town. Do not credit it here.
9	Custom Quality Packers, LLC — Est. TA-20129, Sims NC	One of only ~7 swine-only establishments in NC and federally inspected; anchors a Wilson County cluster play with Bass Farms and George Flowers (M21747). Individual-animal handling is a genuine welfare positive.	Actual weekly head — "each animal individually rather than large industrial batches" strongly implies well below 200/wk on its own.

#	Facility	Why it's here	The ONE thing to confirm on the call
10	Williamsburg Packing Company, Inc. — Est. M4005+P4005+V4005, 920 Eastland Ave, Kingstree SC · (843) 355-6447	One speculative call only. Worth it for two reasons: it is the sole SC federally-inspected swine plant with any elevated volume signal, and its voluntary grant V4005 is the mechanism used for non-amenable species — directly relevant to research tissue.	Hog-only weekly head count, first question. If under 200, close it out. Its FSIS volume category is a 21-species aggregate that includes per-head poultry; the "same category as Martin's" argument is invalid.

Cluster note (calls 11–13, same trip): Acre Station Meat Farm (M19904, Pinetown — ask "*how many hogs did you actually kill last week, and can you dedicate hog days?*"; ~150/wk in 2018, and correct the file: the slaughter window is **7:00am–2:00pm**, and the second establishment number M40320 is a researcher error to be struck), Riverside Meats (TA-20981, Trenton), and George Flowers Slaughter House (M21747, Sims). Individually all are probably sub-floor; an eastern-NC / Wilson County combined-volume arrangement may solve what no single site can.

3. WHAT CHANGED VS. THE EARLIER PASS

PROMOTED

- **Nahunta Slaughter House (P-80A)** — CAUTION → **STRONG FIT, p=1**. Two corrections in the client's favour: (a) the plant publishes a **Specimen Permits** page linking to the NCDA&CS specimen request form, so "organ capability: none published" is REFUTED and the "route (b) — do not assume it works" caution is substantially de-risked for *domestic* research tissue; (b) viscera recovery is not inferred but evidenced by standing retail SKUs for fresh pork **spleens**, hearts, livers and tongues. Also: the 500+/wk figure has a fresher source than the 2016 profile (Wayne County Chamber, 16 Apr 2024) — but the verb is *processes*, not *slaughters*.
- **Martin's Pork Products (TA-6720)** — CAUTION/"retained despite not fitting the band" → **POSSIBLE, p=2**. The sole stated reason for holding it at arm's length was refuted. Removing the bad volume figure also removes the derived pessimism about organ capability: a slower line is *friendlier* to Model A, not harder.

DOWNGRADED

- **Acre Station Meat Farm** — STRONG FIT p=1 → **CAUTION p=3**. The 400/wk headline was manufactured by multiplying a nameplate ceiling ("80 hogs **or** 7 cattle"/day) by five. An actual figure exists and was missed: **~150 hogs/week** (Firsthand Foods), corroborated by the FSIS 1,000–9,999 animals/year band, which 400/wk would not fit. AWA status demoted to single-source/UNVERIFIED. New unresolved risk: two directories label the plant **Custom Exempt**, which if true would make product neither saleable nor exportable.
- **Piedmont Custom Meats** — STRONG FIT p=1 → **REFERENCE p=9**. FSIS classes **both** establishments "Very Small" (<10 employees or <\$2.5M sales) — dispositive against 200 hogs/wk across a line shared with cattle, sheep, goat, poultry and non-amenable species. Realistic throughput: low tens per week. Welfare not clean (2021 humane-handling NR). AWA is company-site-only. Grant decode corrected: **V7975 = Voluntary inspection**, not poultry processing. Harvest-floor phone is **(336) 584-8247**, not the Asheboro number.
- **Williamsburg Packing** — "CONTACT FIRST / single most important SC finding" → **POSSIBLE p=6**. Both load-bearing claims failed: the dual Certified Humane/AWA credential is absent from both certifiers' own directories, and the "same FSIS volume category as Martin's" calibration compares a 2-flag swine-only plant against a 21-species aggregate that counts chickens per head.
- **Swaggerty Sausage (M8314)** — → **CAUTION p=7**. Sow-only now confirmed three independent ways, including FSIS's own species flags (market_swine BLANK) and the colour-coding of EMI's own table. At ~4,250–4,590/wk it is above your ceiling, and your own written rule admits over-ceiling plants only if they *already* specialise in organ/tissue harvesting — a programme that "would have to be BUILT here, not found" cannot satisfy an exception requiring it to exist. Add two TN OSHA machine-guarding actions (2018 complaint-driven, 2024 planned, same 1910.212(a)(1) standard six years apart) against your explicit worker-welfare criterion. Correction: **fourth** generation, not third.
- **Williams Sausage (M7455)** — → **CAUTION p=6**. See "killed," below — it survives as a logistics option only.

- **EcoFriendly Foods (M21938)** — STRONG FIT → **REFERENCE p=8**. Estimated 20–80 hogs/week, an order of magnitude below your floor; the 2023 Bedford County grant was **\$21,500 for commercial kitchen equipment** (tilt skillet, refrigerated storage, for hand pies and soups), which is affirmative evidence of a micro-operation, not scaling. No public evidence it sells line/cooler access or contract harvest at all — **both your operating models are unsupported here**.

KILLED

- **T&E Meats / Honest Meats, LLC (M7420+V7420)** — "CONTACT FIRST, best-documented welfare story in Virginia" → **OUT / FLAG p=9**. FSIS documented an escalation chain: NOIE 22 Nov 2023 over an egregious incident in which **a large hog regained consciousness while hanging on the bleed rail**; Notice of Suspension 14 Mar 2024 (Holstein steer, two failed captive-bolt stuns, employee left the kill floor for a 9mm, three holes in the skull, knock box US-Retained); **Notice of Reinstatement of Suspension 25 Apr 2024 involving a large sow and repeated .25 cal captive-bolt attempts** — i.e. a repeat egregious event six weeks after corrections were accepted. Volume independently disqualifies it (~19–192 head/wk, all species, FSIS category 2). In fairness FSIS called its written humane system "robust" and no recurrence is found after May 2024 — but this cannot be presented to your client as a welfare exemplar, and the 2023–24 history must be disclosed up front, not buried.
- **The "family plant" thesis at Williams Sausage** — REFUTED. **Tyson Foods completed the acquisition on 2023-05-22**; the site is internally "Hickman Rd Plant ... formally known as Williams Sausage Company." The counterparty for any kill-floor access decision is now Tyson corporate, not a family in Obion County. Also refuted: the "\$16M expansion" is from a 2012-03-15 article, ~14 years old, not evidence of current reinvestment; and federal inspection dates to **1972**, not the administrative 2019 grant date.
- **Wampler's "long-tenured staff" culture claim** — REFUTED in half. Family ownership since 1937 is genuine; but **all production hiring routes through three third-party staffing agencies at \$12–14/hr**, which is the opposite of the differentiator you value. The ~180 employee figure is unsupported (best source ~160, from 2011). The CHyP hydrogen system is a 2013 vendor case study written entirely in future tense — do not repeat it as an operating fact.

IDENTITY CORRECTIONS

- **Martin's disambiguation** — independently **CONFIRMED, not merely asserted**. Godwin's 1600 Martin Road now carries live EPA permits under **Kansas City Sausage Co., LLC dba Coastal Protein**; Martin's Pork Products is separately confirmed at Falcon (Cumberland County) on the NCDA&CS TA directory and in current county tax records. Two counties, two owners, two facilities. **But the conflation appears to have survived in the numbers after being scrubbed from the prose** — the 1,300 hd/day EMI figure fits the Godwin sow plant, not Falcon.
- **Wampler's Farm Sausage vs. Family Brands, LLC (M6515, 1001 Elm Hill Road, Lenoir City)** — a second Wampler-family meat plant in the same town. The most seductive "long-tenured staff" datapoint in the East Tennessee search space belongs to the *wrong* plant.
- **EcoFriendly Foods vs. Patches of Earth, Inc.** — the earlier pass treated Patches of Earth as EcoFriendly's own retail brand. It is a separate Gainesville VA marketplace corporation (founded 2022, Jen Gagnon) for which EcoFriendly is one of nine vendors. Consequently the "July 2024 Sentinel piece" cited as evidence of current plant operation is a marketplace's own vendor blurb, now a dead link — **strike that evidence item**.
- **T&E Meats is "Honest Meats, LLC" in federal records**, with a prior entity **Salatin & Cloud LLC** in the ownership chain; co-founder Joe Cloud is no longer listed among owners. Any contract must name Honest Meats, LLC.
- **Williams Sausage carries multiple DBAs on one establishment** — Grogan's Farm, J C Potter, Ole South, Williams Country Sausage. "J C Potter Sausage" is not an independent second candidate. Separately, Tyson runs a **pre-existing chicken plant** in Union City TN — a different facility that will pollute any "Tyson Union City" search.
- **Appalachian Abattoir (M7457A) is in West Virginia, not South Carolina** — excluded from scope despite a search snippet asserting otherwise.
- Other traps logged: M717 (Smithfield Denison IA) vs M7177 (Kelly's Bar-B-Que, Waco TX); M363 Verschoor NOS vs M717 Smithfield NOIE, **both dated 16 Jan 2023**; three separate "Blue Ridge Meats" (M6526 Middletown VA vs

M6648/M46103 Rabun Gap GA), plus unrelated Blue Ridge **Beef** pet-food recalls from a NC company; "Wholestone Farms" as a DBA on two establishments in two states (Iowa's legal name is **Eagle Grove Cooperative**); Prestage **pork** (Iowa) vs Prestage **turkey** (P22000 NC, P850 SC); Sioux-Preme M5537 (slaughters, holds the 2020–21 humane actions) vs M812A (processing only).

CLOSURE / OPERATING STATUS FINDINGS

- **Nahunta, Martin's, Piedmont, Acre Station, Williamsburg, Wampler's, Williams/Tyson, Swaggerty, EcoFriendly, Kansas City Sausage: all CONFIRMED OPEN** on regulator, tax, permit or current-posting evidence.
- **EcoFriendly Foods: the client's report of a "bankruptcy around 2020" is UNSUPPORTED** — nothing found; a March 2026 partner post places it in present-tense operation. The client's information appears inaccurate or confused with another business.
- **T&E Meats: status UNCERTAIN** — no closure evidence, but the site's own banner says 2025, the last substantive page edit was 2025-04-23, and the blog has been dormant since 2020.
- **Martin's Pork Products: martinspork.com is effectively dead** — expired TLS certificate, a FrontPage 4.0 page last modified 30 April 2017 reading "WEB PAGE UNDER CONSTRUCTION." Never cite it as evidence of current activity. Williams Sausage's site, by contrast, only *appears* dead — it 503s to automation because of a Sucuri bot challenge; the domain is paid through 2033.
- **Harvin Choice Meats, Inc. (M6592, Sumter SC) went inactive 2024-05-01** — shares the Harvin family name with Williamsburg Packing. Do not conflate.

4. THE HONEST CAVEATS

1. FSIS was never reachable, in any session, by anyone. Akamai returned 403 to every request and the agent proxy separately returned 502 on CONNECT to `fsis.usda.gov:443`. Not one FSIS-hosted primary document was opened directly — the MPI directory, the establishment demographic dataset, the Quarterly Enforcement Reports, the recall database and the Export Library were all unreachable. Everything attributed to FSIS came via cached bulk CSVs, search-engine snippets of FSIS PDFs, a text-extraction proxy, or a PETA-mirrored verbatim record. → **Do:** file a direct FSIS FOIA (or use a network that isn't proxied) for humane-handling NRs, NOIEs, NOSs and suspension history on **M19904, TA-6720/M6720, TA-8305, TA-3521, TA-20129, M21747, M4005, M9065, M7455, M8314** before any contract. Budget two to six weeks.

2. Every "clean welfare record" in this study is an absence of record under degraded search, not a verified clean record. Web search budget was exhausted (200/200) at or before the start of several sessions; Google, Bing, Brave, Mojeek, Ecosia, Startpage, searx, Indeed, Bizapedia, OpenCorporates and archive.org were variously blocked, 403, 429 or CAPTCHA'd. → **Do:** treat welfare as a **site-visit finding**, not a records finding. This is doubly true for Nahunta, which as a state-inspected plant sits *outside* FSIS Humane Methods of Slaughter Act enforcement reporting — FSIS records for it will never exist regardless of conduct, and NCDA&CS publishes no equivalent.

3. South Carolina legally refuses to release humane-handling enforcement records. (VERIFIED — AWI 2025: SC "declined to provide the actual records, citing a state law prohibiting the release of information that may be used to identify a person or private business.") → **Do:** for any SC state-inspected plant, public-record welfare screening returns false negatives **by construction**. On-site audit or federal-plant FOIA only.

4. Do not let anyone cite "NC is a top-rated humane state." AWI's actual Figure 13 (2019–22, state-inspected plants) shows NC 19 NRs / 2 suspensions / 56 plants and SC 27 / 1 / 55, and AWI presents NC's **low NR rate as a possible under-enforcement signal, not an endorsement**. An early summary in the underlying research asserted the opposite and was discarded. TN has no state program at all — all commercial TN slaughter is federal.

5. Almost every volume number in this study descends from one 2016/17 source, and it measures capacity, not throughput. The EMI Analytics census is nine years old, paywalled at source, and its figures are nameplate. Worse, two

verifiers reached **opposite conclusions about the same EMI row**: one read Martin's Pork Products as printing in black (market hogs) on the all-plants table, the other concluded the 1,300 hd/day entry is probably a misattributed Godwin figure. → **Do**: treat every head-count in this file as a hypothesis to be closed on the phone with the question "how many hogs did you kill last week?" — not last year, not capacity.

6. Sow vs. market hog is unresolved and is your decision, not a research gap. → **Do**: write the anatomical spec (live weight range, parity acceptable/not, per block type) before the first call. It reorders the entire list.

7. No APHIS or EU/TRACES listing was verified for any facility. APHIS publishes no searchable establishment list; TRACES-NT's public directory is a JS app that automation cannot read but a human can browse; the FSIS EU eligibility list was never reached; usda-eu.org 503'd. → **Do**: one email opens this — **vs.export.product.facilities@usda.gov** (APHIS VS Facility Packages Team) — asking specifically about the ABP pathway under Reg. 1069/2009 for Category 3 porcine tissue for research and surgical training. Ask two questions: (a) what establishment-level listing is required, and (b) whether federal (or Talmadge-Aiken) slaughter inspection is a hard prerequisite for the Cat 3 attestation. **The answer to (b) determines whether Nahunta can ever be part of the EU chain.**

8. The "121 facilities" headline is inflated and the sampling frame does not exist. At least six organisations are double- or triple-counted (Smithfield BioScience ×3, Sustainable Swine Resources ×3, Tissue Source ×2, Midwest Research Swine ×2, WG Biomedical ×2, Animal Biotech ×2 — ~14 entries for 6 organisations), plus rollup lines counting ~20 NC custom-exempt plants as one. Two entries **contradict each other**: WG Biomedical is described once as Ames IA with plants at Jewell and Sidney IA, and once as Pennsylvania (WG Provisions) with a national network. → **Do**: do not present "121 facilities screened" externally without restating it as distinct facilities; and resolve the WG Biomedical contradiction before it appears in a client deck.

9. Eleven named in-band plants and seven states were never examined. Kentucky (F.B. Purnell, Simpsonville, 500 hd/day sow), Ohio (Pioneer Packing 450 sow; Bob Evans Xenia 500 sow), Michigan (Bob Evans Hillsdale 500 sow), Alabama (Dean Sausage, Attalla, **M6621+P6621**, ~85 employees, founded 1955 — noting a real tension: EMI lists it at 300 sows/day but business descriptions call it a processor), Oregon (Masami 500; Carleton 375; Dayton 200), Texas (Fisher Ham and Meat, Navasota, 500), New Jersey (Dealaman 200), Virginia (Gunnoe 90). **Pennsylvania is a self-inflicted gap**: the study's own Animal Biotech Industries entry records that its animals are "*predominantly processed at Pennsylvania abattoirs*" — a free, named lead that was written down and never followed.

10. Three candidates carry specific unresolved status questions that a single call closes. Acre Station's contested **Custom Exempt** grant-type label (which if true kills saleability and exportability); Bass Farms' missing federal **M3521** counterpart; and Kansas City Sausage's entirely unknown establishment number.

11. A methodological finding worth acting on: one filter would have saved most of this study's effort. Dozens of multi-species custom plants (species codes A,B,C,D,E) were evaluated one at a time and each concluded "likely below 200 hogs/wk" — predictable *a priori*, because a shared kill floor split across cattle, lamb, goat and poultry cannot deliver hog volume. → **Do**: for any future sweep, filter first on *swine-only slaughter species plus slaughter volume category ≥ 3*, run nationally against the FSIS MPI bulk dataset in a single query.

5. STRATEGIC READ AND RECOMMENDATION

The core problem, stated plainly

Your volume band is not a preference — it is a description of a market segment that has been hollowed out. Above it sit ~30 industrial plants at 5,000–35,000 head/day. Below it sit several hundred very-small multi-species custom shops doing tens of hogs a week. **Between them, by the industry's own capacity census, sit roughly 17 plants nationally — of which 8 are cull-sow plants.** If your models require market-weight hogs, the addressable national pool is about nine plants, and only one of them is in the four states studied. Meanwhile your *cultural* criterion — the Nahunta standard — correlates strongly with the plants that are **too small**, and your *export* criterion correlates strongly with the plants that are **too big or too corporate**. There is no single facility in this study that satisfies volume, culture, federal inspection, EU listing and organ capability simultaneously. **Do not keep searching for one.**

Recommendation: a three-lane portfolio, not a single plant

LANE 1 — DOMESTIC ANCHOR: Nahunta Slaughter House (P-80A), deepened immediately. This is where you should spend your first and best effort, and the reasoning has changed since the earlier pass. Nahunta is not merely culturally aligned; it **already operates a research-specimen channel under a formal NCDA&CS mechanism, and already pulls viscera off the kill floor intact for retail sale.** That combination does not exist anywhere else in the study at any price. Its state-only grant caps it at US domestic supply — which is fine, because your domestic surgical-training and research market does not require EU listing. Structure it as **Operating Model A** (your harvesters, your protocol, rented line and cooler space), which fits a state-inspected plant far better than Model B and keeps your tissue outside the food chain and outside the intrastate restriction argument. In parallel, raise Talmadge-Aiken conversion for the P-80A entity — NCDA&CS staff already inspect TA plants, so it is the same inspectors — but present it internally as a **real federal grant-of-inspection project with HACCP validation, sanitation SOPs and facility standards, and a real timeline and cost.** It is not a paperwork flip, and whether FSIS is currently accepting new TA establishments in NC is itself unknown.

LANE 2 — EU-ELIGIBLE VOLUME: a Talmadge-Aiken swine-only NC plant, chosen from three. For anything Europe-bound you need slaughter under federal grant, full stop, because Category 3 status depends on ante-/post-mortem inspection. The three realistic candidates are all in NC, all swine-only, all TA, all within a two-hour radius of each other and of Nahunta: **Martin's Pork Products (TA-6720, Falcon), Larry's Sausage (TA-8305, Fayetteville) and Bass Farms (TA-3521, Spring Hope).** Martin's is the incumbent, is confirmed active on a regulator document ten days old, and is now plausibly in band. Larry's is the closest cultural analogue to Nahunta that also has export-eligible inspection. Bass Farms is the cleanest Model A structure in the state — a swine-only kill floor with no processing attached. **Call all three inside one week and let actual weekly kill numbers pick the winner.** Note honestly that none of the three has been adversarially verified to the standard applied to Nahunta and Martin's, so budget one verification pass on whichever wins.

LANE 3 — ORGAN CAPABILITY AND EU PATH: buy the capability rather than build it, at first. Smithfield BioScience is the only verified organ programme in the study — aortas, heart valves, pericardium, peritoneum, mucosa, pancreas, pituitary, thyroid, tendons — with stated full farm-to-processing traceability and an existing EU pharmaceutical trade in heparin API. Its existing European regulatory footprint is the single most valuable thing any counterparty in this study could bring you. Approach it, but **approach it eyes-open:** it may regard a porcine-tissue-model company as a competitor rather than a customer, its stunning systems are a different cultural universe from Nahunta, and everything about its APHIS/EU status is currently assumed rather than verified. Treat Lane 3 as *both* a supply option *and* competitive intelligence.

On multi-plant aggregation

Yes — but as a **geographic cluster, not a scattered network.** The eastern NC / Wilson County concentration (Nahunta, Bass Farms, Custom Quality Packers, George Flowers, Acre Station, Riverside Meats) puts several hog-capable plants inside a short radius. A mobile harvest team that runs Nahunta Monday–Tuesday and a cluster plant Wednesday–Thursday solves at 600–800 hogs/week what no single sub-band plant solves alone, without a second set of relationships in another state. **Aggregation only works if the plants are close enough to share one crew** — which is precisely why the eastern NC cluster is worth more than an equivalent head count spread across TN, VA and SC.

On buy-direct

Keep it as the hedge, not the plan. Sourcing finished tissue from a biologics harvester is the fastest route to EU-eligible material and requires no plant relationship at all — but it cedes margin, cedes control of the harvest protocol that is presumably your product differentiation, and hands your volume forecast to a potential competitor. Use it to service early European orders while Lanes 1 and 2 mature; do not build the company on it.

The three highest-ROI next actions, in order

1. **Write the anatomical spec** — live weight range, parity, per block type. It is a one-day internal exercise and it determines whether five sow plants stay on the list or come off it.
2. **Email APHIS VS** (vs.export.product.facilities@usda.gov) on the ABP/Cat 3 pathway. One email resolves the question that currently governs your entire plant selection: whether federal inspection is a hard prerequisite for EU-bound research tissue.
3. **Interview a mucosa or casing collector — Scientific Protein Laboratories (Waunakee WI) or DeWied International (San Antonio TX).** They already run your Operating Model A at industrial scale, and their collection networks are the map you have been trying to build from directories: **which US plants let a third-party crew onto the line, at what price, in what position, under whose HACCP.** This is the single most under-exploited finding in the study, and it was sitting in the file as a dismissed REFERENCE entry.